

Dear Members of the Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office,

My name is Dr. Noah Grand. When I was getting my PhD at UCLA, I studied and taught classes on the role of social networks in the economy. These are the type of classes that I would have gone on to teach in an MBA program if MBA programs were hiring in my specific research areas, but I was ahead of my time.

It is important to understand what so-called Artificial Intelligence (AI) is. These are highly sophisticated statistical models that try to come up with a probabilistic answer to a question or analysis of a problem. Imagine you are trying to figure out what you want to eat for dinner. A good AI model could understand the types of food you like to eat, a good diet for the average person, whether you have allergies like a severe peanut allergy, and order your dinner for you via an app like Uber Eats. However, these statistical models cannot get the order right. They could order vegetarians a steak or a car ride to go to a restaurant instead of bringing food to our doorstep. Imagine if they ordered a meal with peanuts for our friend with a deadly peanut allergy!

Even more importantly, our national economy rests on a backbone of intellectual property law, something AI leaders want to violate. Earlier this week, [OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claimed](#) that he needs to violate copyright laws and feed copyright protected work into his company's new language models to try and compete with China.

It is important to remember why, for a century, companies from around the world have wanted to invest in countries like the United States instead of countries like China. The United States will protect companies' intellectual property. China does not. Sam Altman wants to ruin a backbone of the American economy so his unprofitable company can grow even larger. The free market should take its course and wipe out OpenAI, which does not have any end product to sell businesses or individual consumers.

Statistical analysis benefits the United States and American companies. So do many other types of research. However, the types of research that companies call "Artificial Intelligence" does not. They only provide minimal benefits at a routine task like computer coding, because these statistical models are a high risk of adding part of the wrong code from a different task. A human has to go through and review AI code line by line. This work is tiring since code can be so detailed and a misplaced comma or accidentally capitalized word can crash a program. (I've made both mistakes in my day.)

Fundamentally, AI does not benefit the United States.

It reminds me of the financial and banking crash of 2008. Many companies had data of what they owned. Others did not. Whether they had the data or not, what they lacked was the ability to understand the data. Technology companies like OpenAI love to gather as much data as possible. They say, "trust us, we're technical wizards, we can figure out how to use the data."

I'm going to assume you have tried to use Google search in the last few years. Tell me, how is that AI powered search working out for you? It's getting worse, isn't it.

As someone who did data analysis well enough to be hired to teach others how to do it at a top university while still in graduate school, I can tell you that it is incredibly difficult to actually use large data models.

It's been an open secret that when companies who aren't specifically tech companies are looking for "machine learning" or "AI" experience, they are often looking for someone who has a good handle on undergraduate level statistical models plus a more advanced statistical technique or two. This shouldn't be a surprise. These companies need to turn a profit, so they hire people who can actually help the firm. Meanwhile, companies like OpenAI sell a fraudulent dream of the future so they can get a handout from naive people in government and venture capital.

It's important to close on that last word: fraudulent. By taking away copyright protections, tech companies like OpenAI want to commit fraud, stealing the work of Hollywood movie studios and independent writers alike. I earned royalties on 46 separate works in 2024. Companies like OpenAI want to profit from my hard work without paying me a dime. Instead of considering their lobbying, people like Sam Altman should be arrested for grand theft.

Sincerely,
Dr. Noah Grand
(Commenting as an individual)

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